ANATOMY OF A DISASTER

THE TRIPLE TRAIN CRASH AT BAHANAGA BAZAR STATION NEAR BALASORE HAS LEFT 288 PEOPLE DEAD, OVER 1,100 INJURED AND SEVERAL QUESTIONS UNANSWERED. HERE'S A BLOW-BY-BLOW ACCOUNT OF WHAT TRANSPIRED ON JUNE 2

Graphic by **NILANJAN DAS**



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- The loco pilot sees that even the Home Signal post, 180 m from the station, is green, continues at 128 kmph
- The signal error sends the train into the loop line instead of the main line, where it crashes into the stationary freight train

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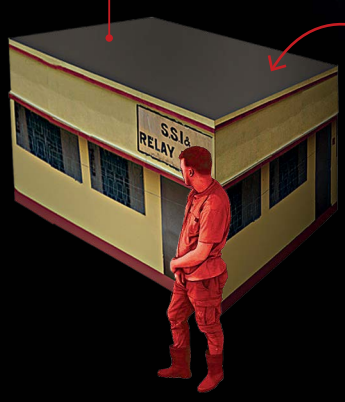
- The loco pilot of the Coromandel Express sees the green light at the Distant Signal post 2 km from the station, and continues at the maximum speed of 130 kmph
- The signal should actually have been yellow because, by then, the main line is erroneously connected to the loop line. The train should have slowed down

Yeshwantpur-Howrah Express coming from Bengaluru

TO HOWRAH

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- The SSI informs the SM that the work is done, reconnects boom barrier to interlocking system **(not physically verified by SM/SSI)**
- This is where the anomaly that resulted in the crash is suspected to have occurred



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A freight train carrying iron ore pulls into the loop line, waiting for the Coromandel Express to use the main line



- The Relay Hut houses the SIS junction box
- Has 10+ sets of relay panels, with 16-20 switches on each, controlling signals, track points, boom barriers

Coromandel Express coming from Shalimar en route to Chennai